PassFrame
TUITION

The Ant and the Butterfly

Year 4 — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Fiction (Fable)

Extract — read it carefully before answering

One golden summer, a butterfly called Iris spent her days drifting from flower to flower, admiring her own reflection in the dewdrops. Below her, an ant named Moss worked without rest, carrying crumbs and seeds back to her nest beneath the old oak tree.

'Why do you work so hard?' Iris laughed, fluttering past. 'The sun is shining and summer will last forever!'

'Summer never lasts forever,' replied Moss, trudging onward with a seed twice her size balanced on her back. But Iris only laughed harder and flew off towards the meadow.

Weeks passed. The golden days grew shorter, and one morning a bitter wind swept through the meadow, scattering leaves like confetti. Iris's wings, so beautiful in summer, were useless against the cold, and she shivered beneath a drooping leaf, hungry and alone.

It was Moss who found her there. Without a word, the little ant brought her a crumb of bread and a seed from her own winter store.

'I thought you said summer would last forever,' said Moss gently. Iris lowered her eyes. 'I was wrong. Thank you for your kindness.' From that day on, whenever Iris saw an ant at work, she remembered the winter the ants had saved her life.

Questions

20 min · 12 questions

1. What was Iris the butterfly doing while Moss the ant worked?

2. What did Moss carry back to her nest?

3. Underline the sentence that tells you Iris did not believe summer would end.

4. Underline the simile that describes the falling leaves.

5. What does “trudging” tell you about the way Moss was walking?

6. True or false: Moss helped Iris even though Iris had laughed at her.

7. Why do you think Iris's wings were “useless against the cold”?

8. What two things did Moss bring to Iris in the winter?

9. In your own words, explain the lesson this fable is trying to teach.

10. Why do you think the author chose an ant and a butterfly for this story, rather than two of the same creature?

11. How do you think Iris felt when she said “I was wrong”? Use evidence from the text.

12. Do you agree with how Moss treated Iris? Explain your answer.